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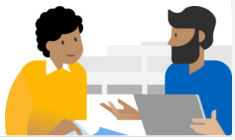
Priyansh Choudhary

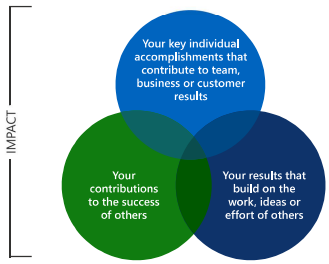
SOFTWARE ENGINEER II | Reports to: Shashank Rachamalla

Connect May 2025

Reflection Period: Aug 12, 2024 - May 6, 2025

Connects provide a regular touchpoint where you and your manager can come together with a growth mindset to reflect on impact and discuss areas for improvement and future development.







Fixed Mindset leads to a desire to look smart and therefore a tendency to avoid challenges, give up easily, see failures as fruitless or worse, ignore useful negative feedback and feel threatened by the success of others.



Growth Mindset leads to a desire to learn and therefore a tendency to embrace challenges, persist in the face of setback, see failures as essential to mastery, learn from criticism and find lessons and inspiration in the success of others.

Reflect on the past

At Microsoft, we have high performance expectations of everyone. We must strive to deliver on ambitious goals, accelerate our culture and act with speed and urgency. Capture what you've accomplished and learned since your last Connect.

Summarize your impact

Core priorities

What impact did you have for each of your core priorities?

Sno.	What was delivered?	What Impact/results are accomplished? (Metric - KPI / OKR/ SLAs/ effort savings/ COGS reduction/etc.	What Attributes were (Attribu Quality/Design/Code/Te Microsoft Values - Resp Custo
1	**Vault Tier Restore Improvements** • Fixed a major bug, where using the same recovery point twice caused restore failures • Refactored BSL & Restore CR validation flow in the shim • Improved post-cleanup of Config Maps and BSLs • Added pre-validation to block invalid Custom Resources	• **Prevented downstream restore failures** from invalid CR reuse • **Reduced customer impact via** early validation • Increased restore **reliability and consistency**	**Quality, Design, Custome**
2	**Region & Infrastructure Expansion** • Achieved GA parity and tracked enablement backup support in 11 new regions • Upgraded SDKs for OTDS (cleanup), SPH (flows), and Test repos • Deployed and enabled runners in new regions for backup, restore, and CRR	• **Unblocked backups** for customers in newly launched regions • **Onboarded new customer segments** • **Modernized internal codebase via** SDK upgrades	**Execution, Collaboration**
3	**Hardening Vault Store Improvements** • Fixed RA false positives (failures marked as success which gave inaccurate measures) • Added error handling for tiering failures when Storage Account is private • Investigated commit-409 RA bug • Investigated hardening edge cases which require ReIR	• Improved **SLA accuracy** by **eliminating silent failures** and fixing kusto queries. • **Enhanced monitoring** and alerting precision • Identified and surfaced ReIR-related edge defects to **reduce redundant failures.**	**Quality, Problem Solving**

	• Improved SLA dashboards and Kusto queries for hardening to accurately measure success. • As part of operability found potential bugs during investigations of multiple failures.		
4	**AKS Operation Tier Enhancements** • Fixed List CRDs memory-consumption issue in the extension • Mapped and categorized new SWW cases • Improved TA calls resiliency to avoid throttling • Prevented backups when the snapshot controller was disabled • Added null/empty-param validation in SPH • Fixed Velero warnings by pulling fixes from upstream • Tuned backup/restore timeouts to prevent borderline failures • Scrubbed backup timing-out clusters to help them succeed.	• Resolved **failures** due to OOM kills in customers with High CRDs for all operations. •**Improved SLA** by adding **resiliency**, preventing failures due to intermittent issues. • **Increased backup success rates** by preemptively handling errors • **Reduced customer pain** from unsupported volumes, **undetected user errors** and timeouts	**Quality, Security, Design,**
5	**BVT/Runner Improvements** • Added IR tests for Vault BVTs across regions • Fixed bugs in AKS Vault BVTs for Resource creation and cleanups • Added validation & prerequisite tests for Vault GA • Automated stale-role cleanup in BVTs • Onboarded runners for AKS & CRR in new regions • Updated TA Version to correct status-code responses.	• **Broaden test coverage** and reliability for GA • Reduced manual cleanup effort via automation • Supported multi-region testing readiness	**Quality, Automation, Col**
6	**Customer Support CRIs / Queries** • Unblocked two long-running customer cases (>1 mo.) • Guided CSS on hardening, pruning and network issues in/out of K8s • Resolved SWW cases (restore, label selection, CLI/Terraform inputs) • Updated existing TSGs & created new TSGs for vault-hardening troubleshooting • Received appreciation from CSS folks over mail for the same.	• Shortened customer downtime for issues in services. • Reduced CSS escalations through improved TSG • Increased team self-sufficiency in diagnostics	**Customer Obsession, Cor Craftsmanship**
7	**Productivity Improvements for Team** • Cut SPH merge-validation time by 30 min for faster feedback. • Built a one-command customizable script to churn PVC data and stand-up scale-test clusters in very less time. • Created Kusto queries and onboarded Vault Tier analytics into MSR • Drove AKS Backup Extension Release end-to-end.	• Accelerated PR cycles and test setup • Saved hours of manual effort on scale tests • Updated Vault Tier failure analysis	**Innovation, Execution, Le**
8	**Team & Collaboration Contributions** • Improved resource-cleanup so no workloads remain in Configuring Protection (helped Ankur, Chang, Yash Vohra) • Completed weekly operability analysis for Soumya (uncovered restore bug) • Tested downscaling/tiering with Soumya (introduced ReIR logic) • Assisted Dishant on SFI auth removal • Reproduced cancellation issues with Aditya • Guided Komal on SPH & RA-infra vault debugging • Investigated CRI trusted-access errors with Dishant & Mayank • Validated CLI/PowerShell flows for Vault GA for Soumya • Helped Rajath in AKS backup flows setups and hardening.	• Prevented cleanup failures and state inconsistencies • Fixed production restore bugs • Accelerated Vault GA readiness • Strengthened team problem-solving throughput	**Collaboration, Accountal**
9	**Leveraging Others' Work** • Reused existing MSR queries to onboard and triage failures • Received guidance from Anshul, Shashank & Mayank on AKS & disk backup E2E • Partnered with Shashank Singh on SWW-case triage • Leveraged existing BVTs to create CRR-BVT E2E flows • Collaborated with Pratik & Rajath for MVT improvements	• Accelerated onboarding and debug time • Improved efficiency by reusing proven methods • Enhanced team synergy and knowledge sharing	**Collaboration, Learning A**
10	**OSS Contribution** • Merged a Velero PR to add missing Resource Modifier in supported API types	• Community Help	**Learning**
11	**Security Fixes** • Discovered and reported SAS-URI token logging issue • Applied CG fixes in SPH packages	• Closed a security gap exposing sensitive tokens • Raised SPH codebase security hygiene	**Security Awareness, Qua**
12	**Disk Restore Enhancements** • Added DAO support in disk restores (SPH & common) • Prevented cross-subscription restores for disks with DAO • Investigated and fixed missing DAO in PITC by pulling it from the snapshot URL	• This has still ***not gone into production*** • Made DAO retrieval logic more robust	**Quality, Design, Data-Dri**

Diversity & Inclusion (D&I) Core Priority

What impact did your actions have in contributing to a more diverse and inclusive Microsoft?

> Over the past cycle, I participated in several group-focused discussions, particularly around design changes in our services.
>
> - These conversations not only allowed me to voice my ideas but also created space for diverse perspectives, helping build stronger collaboration within and across teams.
> - This consistent involvement helped me establish a broader presence beyond my immediate group.
> - I received encouraging feedback from teammates for acknowledging their inputs thoughtfully and ensuring their ideas were considered during discussions.
>
> I also contributed actively to ongoing projects by sharing fresh ideas aimed at improving team productivity.
>
> Additionally, I remained committed to **being bold** which I was mot when I first joined, I took steps to confront people and convince them where I felt m point was right and not get convinced by them. This helped me in my personal growth in the org.

Security Core Priority

What impact did your actions have in contributing to a more secure Microsoft? You can still capture progress even before you set your Security Core Priority for the first time.

> I proactively identified and reported a case where a SAS URI token was being inadvertently logged, helping close a potential security loophole before it could impact users.
> I also took initiative to apply CG fixes across critical SPH packages, improving overall security hygiene and compliance.
>
> By addressing these issues within the same release cycle, I helped maintain a clean and compliant codebase and minimized risk exposure.

Manager comments

Circle of Impact	Short description of work	Impact/Results and HOW (OKR, SLA improvement, Customer Obsession, Growth Mindset etc.)	Impact Rating
IC - Feature	**AR'25** **All region support for AKS ops-tier and vault-tier** This involved upgrading AKS ARM SDK in Common, SPH, Store & Test repos to support CRUD calls to AKS RP for new regions. Priyansh also deployed the AKS runners for these regions. **Disk Restore enhancements** Added support to send Disk DAO during disk restores (SPH & common) given Disk RP added additional validations and blocked calls without DAO (if snapshot already had one) Block cross-subscription restores for disks with DAO **AKS Velero plugin E2E tests infra** - Came up with a one pager design doc to enable test execution for Velero Azure plugins (github) on our Azure infrastructure.	Opened up 11 regions where AKS had support but backup not present. Disk restore to succeed for DAO customers.	Very quick rampup on Store & OSS. Faced multiple dll conflicts, resolved them independently. Stretched to complete the change and testing in a short time to meet prot deployment timelines.
IC - Fundamentals Quality/Productivity	**AKS SLA** Fixed List CRDs memory-consumption issue in the extension for large clusters. Moved to GET calls instead. Mapped and categorized new SWW (succeeded with warning) cases to give better messaging to users for skipped resources. All calls from Backup control plane to AKS extension go via AKS trusted access gateway. Added polly retries for transient errors hitting this gateway, bumped up the api-version we use for trusted access calls and fixed contract. Correct user error mapping and guidance for CSI snapshot feature disabled for customer clusters. Tuned backup timeouts to support clusters with large number of disks (deployment pending) Fixed Retention agent false positives (failures marked as success) in Tiering workflow. This helped get accurate SLA in vault tier daily stats. Created Kusto queries and onboarded Vault Tier analytics into MSR **AKS BVTs**	4 clusters had impact because of List CRDs issue. Deployment pending. Better user experience and warning messages for resources we skip during backup. 2 - 3 BVT/customer bakcup failures per month to zero failures after improving resiliency for trusted access gateway calls. Improved SLA by 0.2% through better user error mapping for CSI snapshot feature disabled. Merge validation time improved by 30 mins for SPH builds. Stabilized ECY BVTs after 2 weeks of follow-ups with partner teams by adding multiple resiliency fixes.	For a specific change related to mapping a skipped backup resource to succeeded with warning, Priyansh pulled fix from upstream to show the correct warning message keeping customer exp. in front seat. Priyansh found that the api-version we are using in portal was also very old and worked with portal team to bump it up. This helped avoid sev2s as these older preview versions got deprecated soon. Drove the discussions with partner teams very well over bridge and tried multiple mitigations to stabilize the ECY BVTs. He demonstrated growth mindset as we had to try multiple fixes even without clear understanding of what will fix things. Some feedback from folks: "I had the opportunity to work closely with Priyansh Chaudhary over the past semester on several key initiatives. Priyansh demonstrates strong ownership and a keen ability to learn and build a deep understanding of complex systems. He has been instrumental in investigating and resolving customer issues, consistently bringing a proactive, team-first mindset to collaborative efforts."

	Added IR, DR & CRR tests for Vault tier BVTs - Stabilized them - overall they are running smooth. Automated cleanup of stale role assignments, Raised compute core quota requests for our subs. Enhanced the resiliency of AKS BVTs by enabling **retry-on-failure mode** in CloudTest sessions. Collaborated closely with **partner teams** on Sev2 BVT failures, implementing key improvements such as **dynamic cluster creation with GUID-prefixed names**, **log enhancements** for tracking cluster and VMSS states, and **optimized wait times** between cluster creation and extension deployment. **Others** Cut SPH merge-validation time by 30 min for faster feedback. (was 1hr before this) Built a customizable script to churn PVC data and stand-up scale-test clusters in very less time. Helped us significantly during GA signoff and more recently during data mover releases.		"Priyansh brings with him a great amount of curiosity and enthusiasm which coupled with his hard working nature helps to land great impact for the team. Priyansh takes proper accountability and ownership of his work and is always ready to help the team in any situation. It is commendable to see him ramp up so well with the complexities of the product and handling operability responsibilities well." "Priyansh is proactive in seeking support when needed, especially in challenging customer scenarios such as TA issues, SPH timeouts, or backup scrubber implementation. This helps ensure timely and well-informed responses.
IC - Fundamentals Supportability	Overall worked on 8 CRIs. Most CRIs were unique issues and Priyansh worked very closely with CSS and customers to resolve them independently. Calling out few below 1. Resource move issue where TA token auth not working 2. Issue related to labels not working. 3. Extension installation issue for AKS private cluster and firewall issue. 4. CRR issue related AKS vault tier where few objects not restored due to policies set on cluster. Priyansh also conducted KT sessions for CSS folks to help them understand how some of our backup scenarios work. Priyansh drove MSR for AKS/Disk last quarter (for the first time) and he did a great job gathering info, analysing it and being well prepared for any questions.		Got positive feedback from multiple CSS folks (called out in feedback section below) on how Priyansh conducted KT sessions to make them understand the product and issue at hand Some feedback from folks: " I would like to extend my sincere gratitude to Priyansh for his exceptional support in the AKS Backup long-running case (2502050050000901). This has been one of the most outstanding collaborations I have experienced with the PG team since joining Microsoft in 2018. Priyansh exemplifies the qualities of a true role model for PG engineers, a consummate professional, highly experienced, dedicated, and always conducting himself with integrity and professionalism."
Helping others & Leveraging others work	• Improved resource-cleanup so no workloads remain in Configuring Protection (helped Ankur, Chang, Yash Vohra) • Completed weekly operability analysis for Soumya (uncovered restore bug) • Tested downscaling/tiering with Soumya (introduced ReIR logic) • Assisted Dishant on SFI auth removal • Reproduced cancellation issues with Aditya Guided Komal on SPH & RA-infra vault debugging • Investigated CRI trusted-access errors with Dishant & Mayank • Validated CLI/PowerShell flows for Vault GA for Soumya • Helped Rajath in AKS backup flows setups and hardening. • Helped load balance BVT analysis when Mayank was OOF due to emergency. Leveraging others work/AI • Reused existing MSR queries to onboard and triage failures • Received guidance from Anshul, Shashank & Mayank on AKS & disk backup E2E • Partnered with Shashank Singh on SWW-case triage • Leveraged existing BVTs to create CRR-BVT E2E flows • Collaborated with Pratik & Rajath for MVT improvements		Priyansh has consistently gone above and beyond, stepping up multiple times to support colleagues during emergencies and extended leaves. His commitment and reliability truly embody a team-first mentality. Kudos to him for demonstrating such a commendable attitude!

Reflect on a challenge or setback

All of us must accelerate our culture by doubling down on growth mindset and challenging our fixed mindsets. Share how you demonstrated a growth mindset by taking personal **accountability for setbacks**, **seeking and providing feedback**, and **applying learnings to have greater impact**.

Consider when you could have done something differently. How will you apply what you learned to make an even greater impact?

Over the past period, I encountered several technical and planning challenges that contributed to delays in completing some of my goals.
Specifically,

- I was unable to finish the upgrade of Velero to upstream 1.14 for CG compliance
- Support private access disks (DES, DAO, Zone) in restore scenarios
- Finalize initial designs for both the Azure Plugin Repo E2E pipeline
- Mechanism to prevent PV2 disks from being backed up

I also planned to build a dashboard for MSR vault tier visibility, which is still pending.

Moving forward, I've started breaking down larger initiatives into smaller milestones with check-in points and proactively surfacing risks earlier during syncs. This is helping me get unblocked faster and improve delivery predictability.

From a broader perspective, I've realized that I tend to stay within the boundaries of my immediate workstream. I noticed peers investing time in understanding cross-functional components and engaging with other teams. I wish to gain a more holistic view of the platform.

Manager comments

Good points Priyansh. However, some of these calls had to be taken to prioritize other important customer issues and CRIs. Some callouts from your peers:

"Priyansh should try to embrace confidence in his day-day interactions and not shy away from being bold in voicing his opinions in front of the team."

"I have occasionally observed instances where the root cause behind the issue was not fully identified. This can sometimes result in misalignment between CSA expectations and engineering responses. However, I see he is improving on this and getting better with more understanding of stack"

Plan for the future

Think about opportunities for impact in the upcoming Connect period. What are your 3-5 core priorities?

Review your core priorities

Core priorities

1. **Disk Workload Improvements**

   Focus areas for the upcoming period to drive business impact:

   - Design and implement support for restoring private access disks (DES, DAO, and Zonal disks) by breaking down the work into manageable phases:
     - Draft the high-level design and implementation approach.
     - Seek team-wide signoff with detailed impact analysis.
     - Ensure minimal and safe changes in the restore path.
   - Review existing restore code paths to identify opportunities for simplification and optimization, improving maintainability and reducing the chance of regressions.
   - Collaborate closely with the Portal, CLI, and PowerShell teams, as well as product managers, to ensure consistent support across all customer touchpoints.

   Success measures:

   - Drive the feature from design to GA with **100% SLA** adherence for each development milestone.
   - Ensure **zero critical or blocking errors** during restore operations involving private access disks in BVT and staging environments.
   - Confirm usage of the feature by **at least one internal or external customer**, validating business value.
   - Achieve full parity in experience across **CLI, Portal, PowerShell, and backend**, confirmed via PM and QE validation.

2. **AKS Workload Improvements**

Focus areas for the upcoming period to drive business impact:

- Proactively identify and address critical bugs affecting backup and restore operations for AKS workloads, with a focus on increasing platform stability and reducing CRIs.
- Implement a mechanism to **prevent PV2 disks from being backed up**, as they are currently unsupported. Engage with the CSI team to explore a long-term path for enabling PV2 support, considering timeout changes and restore reliability.
- Fix the bug where **vaulted AKS workload restores fail due to missing PITC details**. Ensure PITC data is correctly populated to enable successful restore operations.
- Continually improve test coverage and resilience by capturing edge cases and telemetry anomalies discovered during operability reviews and post-incident analysis.
- Build a dashboard for AKS Vault Tier MSR Queries for the team.

Success measures:

- Resolve high-impact bugs (e.g., PV2 prevention, PITC in restore) and validate fixes through E2E and BVT pipelines with **zero regressions**.
- Engage with the CSI team and produce a **proposal or plan** for supporting PV2 disks in backup/restore flows.
- Achieve a **25% reduction in backup/restore-related CRIs** for AKS workloads by improving error handling / TSGs and proactive validation.
- Maintain **100% SLA adherence** for tracking and resolving high-severity AKS issues during the cycle.
- The Dashboard built should help the team in reducing effort writing redundant queries.

3. **Expanding Testing Frameworks for Feature Reliability**

Focus areas for the upcoming period to drive business impact:

- Design and implement **scale test scenarios for vault tier** including restoring very old backups, recent backups, backups with churned data disks, and scenarios involving up to 100 disks per backup, to validate resilience at scale.
- Enhance existing BVT coverage by introducing variations that reflect real-world customer workloads and edge cases.
- Improve stability of backup validation pipelines by addressing flaky or intermittent failures, ensuring consistent and reliable test outcomes.
- Continue collaboration with stakeholders to align test efforts with evolving feature goals and usage patterns.

Success measures:

- Deliver **end-to-end scale tests** in the vault tier validating backup and restore performance under varying load and churn conditions.
- Achieve **100% SLA adherence** for daily BVT execution and actionable issue reporting.
- Ensure >90% coverage of prioritized and GA-bound features in BVTs by the end of the quarter.
- Reduce test flakiness rate, improving confidence in automated test outcomes and release decisions.

4. **Contribute to and Develop from Open-Source Initiatives**

Focus areas for the upcoming period to drive business impact:

- Continue meaningful contributions to Velero, focusing on enhancing integration, fixing critical bugs, and improving product reliability.
- Design and implement a CI pipeline to run unit tests for Velero in Azure environments, ensuring platform compatibility and regression prevention.
- Revisit and complete the previously unfinished upgrade of Velero to upstream version 1.14 to ensure CG compliance.

Success measures:

- Deliver at least 3 impactful contributions to the upstream Velero project in the next 6 months.
- Complete and validate the Velero unit test pipeline in Azure with consistent test reliability across configurations.
- Successfully upgrade and integrate Velero v1.14 with CG-compliant changes into downstream usage.

Diversity & Inclusion (D&I) Core Priority

To realize our mission to empower every person and organization on the planet to achieve more, each and every one of us must help create a diverse and inclusive culture where everyone can bring their full and authentic self, in alignment with our values. Consider how you will **deliver successful impact by consistently demonstrating Microsoft's cultural expectations and values**. Visit the Diversity & Inclusion (D&I) Core Priority page for guidance and examples of impact.

Select and commit to at least one focus area from the options below, or create one of your own.

Practice allyship skills in the moment

Engage in constructive 1:1 or group discussions around D&I

Actively participate in Employee Resource Groups

Complete D&I learning, reflect on new knowledge and practice what I learn

Seek diverse perspectives and incorporate feedback, apply insights from a variety of sources and people

Develop or implement inclusive products, processes, or practices

How will you define success as you activate your D&I Core Priority?

- Successfully participate in at least three 1:1 or group discussions focused on D&I topics each quarter, fostering open dialogue and shared learning.
- Strive to build an atmosphere where team members feel heard and valued by encouraging open sharing of perspectives, especially during planning, retrospectives, or review discussions.
- Join and support ERG events organized around cultural awareness or observance months, helping to broaden team understanding and appreciation for diverse backgrounds.

Security Core Priority

We all have the responsibility to directly contribute to the security of Microsoft and our customers. We must all commit to prioritizing the design, build and delivery of technology, tools, data and processes that meet the highest possible standard of security. **For more information on the Security Core Priority, visit** HRweb.

With this priority, I personally commit to being an active and intentional participant in creating a secure Microsoft by:

- Completing and applying learnings from required Security Foundations and Trust Code (Standards of Business Conduct) trainings.
- Prioritizing security in my own work and ensuring I have anticipated and implemented secure approaches to products, processes and tools **in alignment with our** Secure Future Initiative.
- Committing to leveraging MSProtect to learn more about how I can contribute to securing Microsoft, including reporting any digital or physical security incidents via Report It Now.

- If any code vulnerabilities or deviations from SFI are identified, I will commit to:
  - Reporting them promptly through MSProtect or the appropriate reporting mechanism.
  - Taking ownership to address and fix such issues, aiming to resolve them within the current release cycle wherever feasible.

Manager comments

Looks good.

Identify your opportunities for growth

We are all expected to embrace a growth mindset and focus on continuous learning to deliver successful impact.

What 1-2 actions will you take over the next period to learn and apply new skills and capabilities?

- **Strengthen architectural and debugging skills across backup/restore systems** by working on critical bugs such as PV2 disk handling, PITC restore failures in vault tier, and SAS URI compliance. I'll focus on root cause analysis and proposing sustainable design fixes to improve product resilience.
- **Advance testing and automation capabilities** by developing scale-based test scenarios in vault tier — including backups/restores of churned disks, large volume datasets, and aged data — to validate end-to-end robustness. This also includes enhancing BVT stability and coverage for consistent pipeline outcomes.
- **Broaden cross-team product awareness** by engaging more proactively with CLI, portal, and PM teams during disk feature rollouts, enabling me to think beyond backend and consider full-surface impact.

What support do you need to fulfill these actions? Fill in any that apply.

Opportunities to (optional):

No Response

Perspective or coaching on (optional):

No Response

Learning on (optional):

No Response

Manager comments

Let us sync more in our 1:1s

Conversation starters

Choose any of these optional prompts to continue great conversations with your manager. Write a brief response (1-15 words).

Of my strengths, the ones I'd like to apply more in my work are:

In my work, I feel motivated or energized by:

In my work, I lose motivation or energy from:

I know I can't do everything on my own. I'd like help with:

It can be challenging to prioritize important topics for 1:1 conversations. Plan ahead and flag any of the following topics you'd like to discuss with your manager in upcoming conversations.

Select any conversation topics below, or add your own:

- **Career**: Discuss ways to grow my career to align with my strengths, interest & aspirations.
- **Recognition**: Discuss my recognition preferences and highlight my contributions.
- **Opportunities**: Increase my responsibilities, such as new core priorities, stretch assignments, promotion or becoming a people manager.
- **Alignment**: Clarify priorities and expectations for successful impact.
- **Feedback**: Get input on how I'm doing in my role and how to deliver great impact.

Check out aka.ms/career for resources and guides on developing your career.

Manager comments

NA